The Ghost Squad

Competitive Analysis

Product: Koenigegg Automotive
Course: UX115: UX Research Methods I

Group 7

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Introduction

Competitive analysis is a UX research method used to understand competitors' strengths, weaknesses, strategies, and user experience patterns. This method helps identify industry gaps, usability issues, and opportunities to improve design decisions for a product or service. For this project, a competitive analysis was conducted to evaluate digital experiences within the hypercar industry, focusing on how luxury automotive brands communicate value, usability, and accessibility through their websites.

Competitor Selection & Rationale

According to UX research best practices, competitor analysis should be conducted early in a project to identify market gaps and inform redesign strategies

Selected Competitors:

Rationale

Both companies sell products in the niche hypercar market which targets only the very wealthiest people; people who appreciate high-performance, premium technology and typically want vehicles manufactured by brands with strong reputations for quality, performance and prestige. Each brand uses state-of-the-art digital platforms to create interesting content about their brands, provide information about innovative engineering and design attributes, and ultimately generate prospects via premium, high-quality online experiences.

Competitive Analysis Criteria

The analysis was conducted using the UX115 competitor analysis comparison checklist, which includes:

- Overview of Product
- Strengths
- Weaknesses
- Opportunities for Improvement
- Pricing Model (if applicable)
- Visual Design (layout, typography, color, branding)
- List of Key Pages or Screens
- Usability (task flow, efficiency, clarity, error prevention)
- Information Architecture (navigation, labeling, search, content organization)
- Accessibility (WCAG considerations, keyboard access, contrast, alt text, etc.)
- Responsiveness & Mobile Experience (web and/or mobile app)
- Marketing & Promotion Strategies
- Social Media Presence
- Customer Reviews & Customer Support Experience



Overview

Bugatti:
Bugatti is a luxury hypercar manufacturer emphasizing heritage, craftsmanship, and engineering excellence. Its website functions primarily as a brand storytelling platform rather than a direct e-commerce experience.





Pagani:
Pagani is a boutique hypercar manufacturer known for its emphasis on artistry, craftsmanship, and emotional design. The brand positions its vehicles as hand-crafted works of art, and its website reflects this focus by prioritizing emotional storytelling and brand expression over transactional functionality.

Strengths

Bugatti:
The brand is focused on storytelling in a strong emotional way along with cinematic content through-out its platform using high-end visual quality to develop more powerful and aspirational narratives while still having a very distinct and recognizable voice that maintains its image of being exclusive and prestigious.

Pagani:
Pagani's website excels at conveying emotion and craftsmanship through rich visual storytelling. The use of artistic imagery, detailed close-ups of materials, and narrative-driven content reinforces the brand's identity as a highly exclusive, artisan-focused manufacturer. This creates a strong emotional connection with users and clearly differentiates Pagani from more engineering-driven competitors.



Weakness

Bugatti:
The heavy usage of rich media impairs site performance while providing limited access compliance creates limiting barriers. The site interface lacks task efficiency preventing users from quickly locating and comparing detailed vehicle spec information.

Pagani:
While visually compelling, the website lacks functional depth. Navigation and task-based interactions are limited, making it difficult for users to efficiently access technical specifications or compare models. The heavy reliance on visual storytelling also contributes to usability and performance challenges, particularly for users seeking information quickly.





Opportunities for Improvement

Bugatti:
Bugatti could improve its digital experience by enhancing accessibility in line with WCAG standards, optimizing performance by reducing media load, and introducing clearer pathways for users seeking technical specifications or product comparisons.

Pagani:
Pagani could improve its digital experience by introducing clearer navigation pathways for model exploration, improving task efficiency for users seeking specifications, and enhancing accessibility features to support a wider range of users while maintaining its artistic identity.





Pricing Model

Bugatti:
Bugatti does not display public pricing information. Vehicle pricing is inquiry-based, which aligns with industry norms for ultra-luxury hypercar manufacturers.

Pagani:
Pagani does not display public pricing information. Vehicle pricing is handled through private inquiries, which aligns with the exclusivity and bespoke nature of the brand.

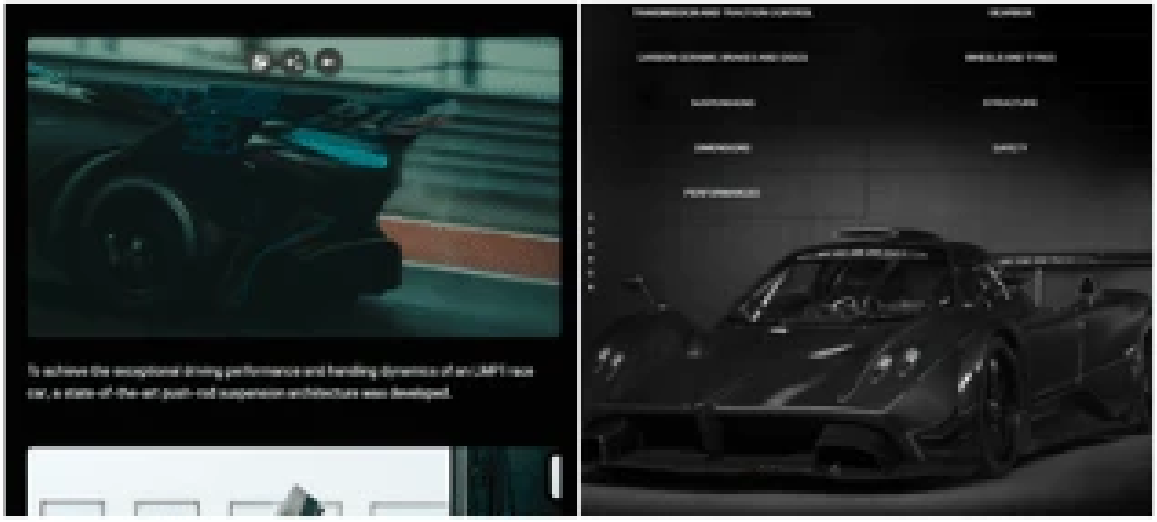




Visual Design

Bugatti:
The website uses a visually immersive layout with large hero sections, elegant typography, and a dark, muted color palette accented with metallic tones. Branding is consistent throughout and strongly reinforces Bugatti's luxury and heritage-focused identity.

Pagani:
The website features an artistic and minimalist layout with refined typography and a muted color palette that highlights materials and craftsmanship. Branding is consistent and emotionally expressive, reinforcing Pagani's image as a luxury, hand-crafted hypercar manufacturer.



Key Pages / Screens

Bugatti:

- Homepage
- Models
- Brand / Heritage
- Craftsmanship
- Dealer Locator
- Contact



Pagani:

- Homepage
- Models
- Craftsmanship
- Heritage / Brand Story
- Atelier / Materials
- Contact



Usability

Bugatti:
The website prioritizes visual storytelling over efficiency. While visually engaging, users must scroll extensively to locate technical details, reducing usability efficiency.

Pagani:
Usability is secondary to emotional storytelling. Users often rely on scrolling and visual exploration rather than structured task flows, which reduces efficiency for users seeking specific information such as performance data or model comparisons.

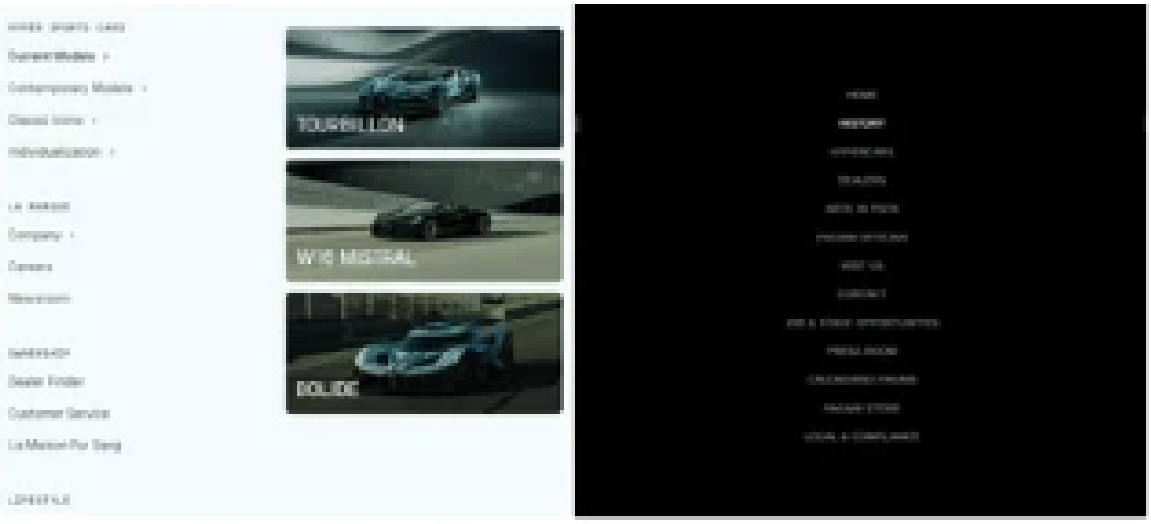




Information Architecture

Bugatti:
Navigation is shallow but brand-centric. Labels emphasize storytelling rather than user tasks, which increases cognitive load for first-time visitors.

Pagani:
The information architecture is shallow but fragmented. Navigation labels are emotionally driven rather than task-oriented, which can create confusion for first-time users unfamiliar with Pagani's terminology or structure.



Accessibility

Bugatti:
Issues with accessibility are due to low colour contrast with text over images, inconsistent or missing alt text for image files and a lack of ability to navigate the website using only the keyboard. These issues contradict the inclusionary design principles taught in the course UX115, which would reduce the usability of the entire experience to people with many different abilities.

Pagani:
Accessibility considerations are limited. The site includes low-contrast text on image-heavy backgrounds and inconsistent use of alternative text. These issues reduce accessibility and conflict with inclusive design best practices emphasized in UX115.



Responsiveness & Mobile

Bugatti:
The site is responsive but suffers from performance delays on mobile due to large assets.

Pagani:
The website is responsive across devices, but mobile usability is impacted by large visual assets and animations, which can slow performance and increase loading times.





Marketing & Promotion Strategies

Bugatti:
Bugatti's digital marketing focuses on emotional storytelling, heritage, and exclusivity rather than direct sales messaging. Calls to action are subtle and secondary to brand narrative.

Pagani:
Pagani's marketing strategy focuses on craftsmanship, exclusivity, and emotional appeal rather than performance metrics or direct sales messaging. The website supports this strategy by acting as a digital brand gallery rather than a conversion-focused platform.





Social Media Presence

Bugatti:
Bugatti maintains an active presence on platforms such as Instagram and YouTube, using cinematic content to reinforce brand prestige and engage luxury-focused audiences.

Pagaini
Pagani maintains an active presence on platforms such as Instagram and YouTube, using visually rich content to showcase craftsmanship, design details, and brand philosophy. Engagement emphasizes artistry and exclusivity over product specifications.



Customer Reviews & Customer Support Experience

Bugatti:

Customer reviews are limited due to the niche market. Customer support is primarily handled through dealerships and direct inquiries rather than public-facing support tools.

Customer Reviews & Customer Support Experience

Public customer reviews are limited due to the niche nature of the brand. Customer support is primarily handled through direct inquiries and dealership relationships rather than public-facing support systems.





S.W.O.T. Analysis - Bugatti

Strengths
Bugatti's strengths include strong global brand recognition and a high-quality visual design that reinforces the brand's luxury, performance, and exclusivity.



Weaknesses
Bugatti's weaknesses include accessibility limitations that reduce inclusivity for diverse users, as well as performance issues caused by heavy media usage, which can negatively impact loading times and overall usability.



Opportunities
Opportunities for Bugatti include improving accessibility to better align with inclusive design standards and expanding interactive product exploration features to enhance user engagement and support informed decision-making.



Threats
A key threat to Bugatti is competitors offering more innovative and user-centered digital UX experiences, which may set higher expectations and draw potential customers away from Bugatti's platform.

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S.W.O.T. Analysis - Pagani

Strengths
Pagani's strengths include a highly distinctive brand identity, emotionally driven storytelling, and a strong emphasis on craftsmanship that differentiates it within the hypercar market.



Weaknesses
Weaknesses include limited usability efficiency, poor accessibility support, and a lack of structured information for users seeking technical or comparative data.



Opportunities
Pagani has opportunities to improve accessibility, enhance navigation clarity, and introduce more task-oriented content without compromising its artistic brand identity.

Threats
A key threat to Pagani is competition from hypercar brands that offer similarly emotional storytelling while also providing more user-centered, accessible, and efficient digital experiences.



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Heuristic Evaluation

Product: Koenigsegg Automotive
Course: UX115: UX Research Methods I

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Introduction (What)

Koenigsegg

The brand Koenigsegg Automotive is a Swedish manufacturer of ultra-high-performance, hand-built hypercars and megacars. The website we will be performing the heuristic evaluation is on www.koenigsegg.com and the date of evaluation is February 7th, 2026

Tools Used:

- Desktop and mobile browsers
- WCAG contrast checker
- Generative AI (for structuring and heuristic brainstorming)

Environment:

- macOS (Chrome, Safari)
- Mobile (iOS Browsers)

Evaluation Goal (Why)

The goal of this heuristic evaluation is to identify usability and accessibility issues on Koenigsegg's website by evaluating the interface against established UX heuristics and best practices.

Unlike competitors such as Bugatti and Pagani, Koenigsegg positions itself as engineering-driven and innovation-focused. This evaluation investigates whether the website effectively supports that positioning by enabling users to:

- Understand Koenigsegg's technical innovations
- Locate and interpret vehicle specifications efficiently
- Navigate the site intuitively without excessive cognitive load
- Access content regardless of ability or device



Evaluators Profile

- **Number of evaluators:** 2
- **Role:** UX student researcher
- **Relevant Experience:**
  - Formal academic training in UX research methods
  - Familiarity with Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics
  - Coursework-based experience with WCAG accessibility principles

Heuristics & Evaluation Criteria

The evaluation was based on:

- Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics
- WCAG 2.1 accessibility guidelines

Heuristic evaluation is recognized in UX research as an effective method for identifying usability issues without user testing. The issues will also be ranked in priority: Low, Medium, and High.



Findings

1. Inefficient Access to Technical Specifications

MEDIUM

Heuristic Violated:

- Recognition rather than recall
- User control and efficiency

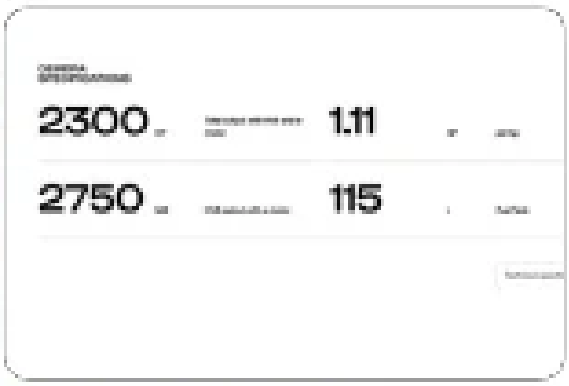
Impact:

- Increased cognitive load
- Reduced efficiency for users comparing models
- Frustration for technically oriented users who value performance data

Koenigsegg's website embeds technical specifications within long, scroll-heavy pages that prioritize storytelling and visual impact. While the information is present, it is not presented in a structured, easily scannable format such as tables or collapsible sections.

Users must remember where information appears across different pages rather than being able to quickly recognize and access it.





* Takes a lot of scrolling just to get to the specifications section.

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Recommendation

Add Structured Specification Tables or Expandable Sections

MEDIUM

Technical vehicle specifications are embedded within long, scroll-heavy storytelling sections. While the information exists, it is not presented in a structured, scannable format. Users must scroll extensively and visually search for performance data such as horsepower, torque, acceleration, drivetrain, or engine type.



Findings

2: Overreliance on Scroll-Based Navigation

MEDIUM

Heuristic Violated:

- User control and freedom
- Flexibility and efficiency of use

Impact:

- Power users cannot efficiently navigate content
- Users lose sense of orientation on long pages
- Mobile users experience increased fatigue

The website relies heavily on vertical scrolling as the primary interaction method. There are limited shortcuts, anchor links, or jump menus to help users move quickly between content sections.





* Almost every page has scrolling animations.

Recommendation

Introduce Anchor Links or Quick Navigation for Long Pages

MEDIUM

The Koenigsegg website relies heavily on long, scroll-based pages that combine visual storytelling, technical information, and brand narratives into a single continuous flow. While this design supports immersive storytelling, it makes it difficult for users to quickly navigate to specific sections such as performance specifications, engineering innovations, or materials. Users must scroll extensively and visually search for content, which increases interaction cost and reduces efficiency—particularly on mobile devices or for users who already know what information they are looking for.



LINK

Findings

3: Limited Visibility of System Status

LOW

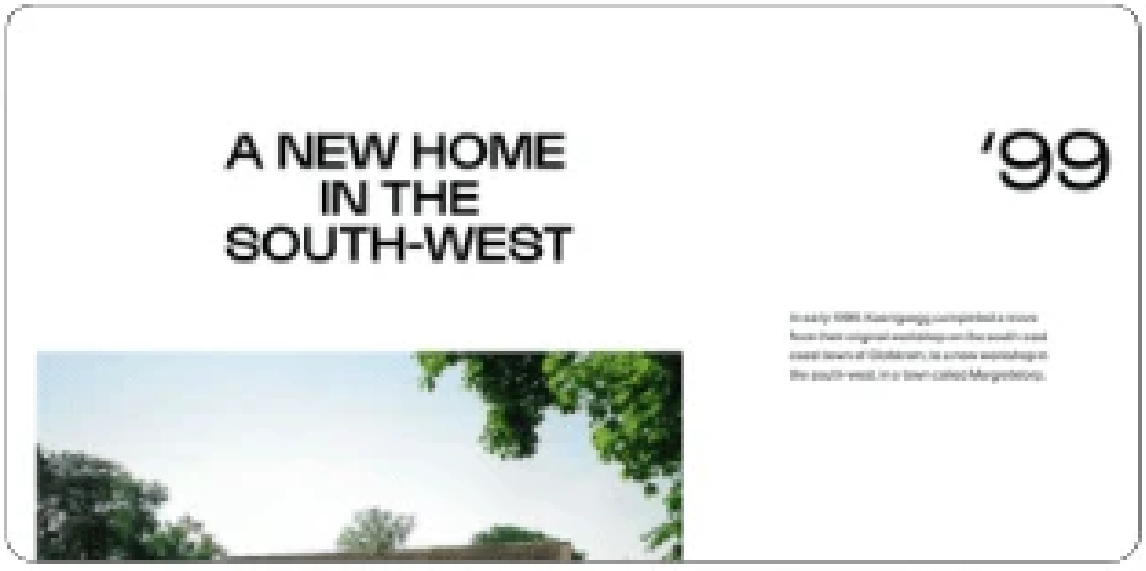
Heuristic Violated:

- Visibility of system status

Impact:

- Uncertainty about whether actions were successful
- Perceived performance issues

Interactive elements such as animations, page transitions, and loading states lack clear feedback. Users are not always informed when content is loading or transitioning, particularly on media-heavy sections.



* There is only a slide animation without a status indicator every time a user navigates to a new page.

Recommendations

Add Clearer Loading and Transition Feedback

LOW

The Koenigsegg website makes extensive use of high-resolution images, videos, animations, and smooth page transitions to support an immersive, premium experience. However, during page loads, media transitions, and interactive animations, the system provides limited or inconsistent feedback to users indicating that content is loading or an action is being processed.
As a result, users may be unsure whether their interaction has been registered or whether the site is still loading, particularly on slower connections or mobile devices.



Findings

4: Accessibility – Color Contrast and Text Readability

HIGH

Heuristic Violated:

- Accessibility (WCAG 2.1)
- Visibility of system status

Impact:

- Uncertainty about whether actions were successful
- Perceived performance issues

Text is frequently placed over images and video backgrounds. In multiple instances, color contrast does not meet WCAG AA standards, making text difficult to read for users with low vision or color sensitivity.



* In the safety systems page, the descriptive text color does not contrast well with the background.

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Recommendations

Improve color contrast and ensure text meets WCAG AA standards

HIGH

The Koenigsegg website frequently places text over high-resolution images and video backgrounds to maintain a visually immersive and premium aesthetic. However, in multiple instances, the contrast between foreground text and background imagery is insufficient, particularly for body text, navigation labels, and overlay captions. This makes text difficult to read for users with low vision, color vision deficiencies, or when viewing the site under suboptimal conditions (e.g., glare, small screens, or reduced brightness).



Findings

5: Lack of a Clear Primary Call-to-Action

HIGH

Heuristic Violated:

- Match between system and real world
- User control and efficiency

Impact:

- Reduced conversion potential
- Missed engagement opportunities

Calls to action such as “Contact Dealer” or “Request Information” are subtle and visually secondary. The interface does not clearly communicate what the next step should be after users explore content.



* If a user wants find a dealer, the link can only be found in the footer and text is really small.



* The button to get more information does not look like a button but part of the body.

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Recommendations

Introduce clear buttons or links for users to explore more

HIGH

The Koenigsegg website emphasizes immersive storytelling through large visuals, scrolling interactions, and minimal interface elements. While this supports a premium aesthetic, some sections lack clearly identifiable buttons or calls-to-action (CTAs) that guide users toward deeper exploration. In several areas, users must rely on scrolling or subtle visual cues to continue navigating, which may not clearly communicate available actions. This can reduce task clarity and create uncertainty about what content is interactive.





LINK

Findings

6: Inconsistent Labeling and Terminology

MEDIUM

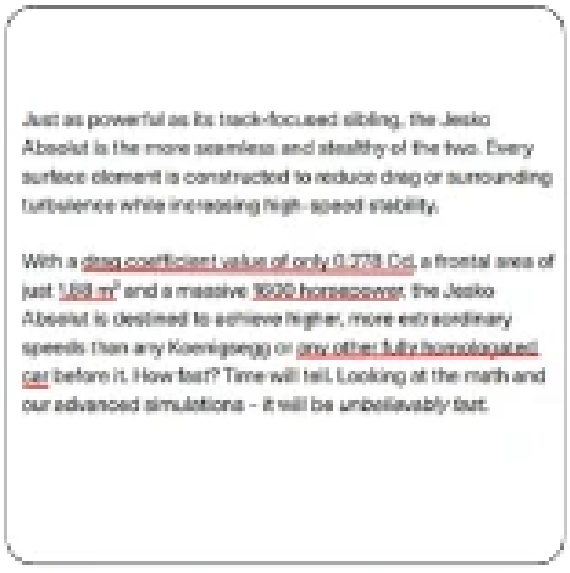
Heuristic Violated:

- Consistency and standards
- Match between system and real world

Impact:

- Increased learning curve
- Reduced clarity for new users

Some navigation labels and section titles use brand-specific or technical language without explanation. While appropriate for enthusiasts, this may confuse first-time users unfamiliar with Koenigsegg's terminology.



* Complex presentation of numbers and terminology will confuse new users.



* Some navigation labels are unconventional to new users, i.e., Megacars.

Recommendations

Simplify terminology or provide contextual explanations

MEDIUM

Koenigsegg's website frequently uses highly technical automotive and engineering terminology (e.g., proprietary system names, advanced powertrain concepts, and performance engineering terms) without providing contextual explanations. While this reinforces the brand's identity as an innovation-driven manufacturer, it may create comprehension barriers for users who are not automotive experts. Terms related to aerodynamics, hybrid systems, drivetrain components, or proprietary technologies are sometimes presented without definitions, tooltips, or simplified descriptions. As a result, users who are unfamiliar with specialized automotive vocabulary may struggle to fully understand the value being communicated.



Summary

This heuristic evaluation revealed that Koenigsegg's website excels in visual storytelling and brand expression but presents usability and accessibility challenges that limit task efficiency and inclusivity. Many issues stem from design patterns common in the hypercar industry; however, addressing these gaps would allow Koenigsegg to differentiate itself as a user-centered, accessible luxury brand.

By improving accessibility, task efficiency, and clarity — while preserving its innovative identity — Koenigsegg can deliver a digital experience that aligns more closely with UX best practices and inclusive design principles.



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